

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

What was Dar al-Islam?

Abbasid Caliphate

Where? Peak? Why did it decline?

What happened in 1258? Why does it matter?

AP EXAM TIP

The Islamic world in 1200 was the most commercially and intellectually advanced civilization — until the Mongols. Know the BEFORE and AFTER of 1258.

Name 4 regional Islamic states that emerged after 1258.

CCOT Question:

What continuities persisted in the Islamic world across the Mongol disruption?

What role did Muslim merchants play in global trade?

DAR AL-ISLAM — 'The House of Islam'

Term for the vast Islamic world stretching from West Africa to Southeast Asia. United by shared religion (Islam), legal framework (sharia), language of scholarship (Arabic), and trade networks. In 1200, it was the world's foremost zone of commercial and intellectual exchange.

THE ABBASID CALIPHATE (750–1258)

Centered in **Baghdad**, the Abbasids presided over a golden age of Islamic scholarship, translation of Greek/Persian texts, and long-distance trade. By the 1200s, the caliphate was already weakened by regional breakaway dynasties (Seljuk Turks held real power) and internal fragmentation.

1258 — MONGOL SACK OF BAGHDAD

- › **Hulagu Khan** (Mongol Il-Khan) besieged and destroyed Baghdad
- › Caliph Al-Musta'sim killed; House of Wisdom library allegedly burned
- › End of the Abbasid Caliphate — the symbolic center of the Islamic world was gone
- › **Mamluk Egypt stopped the Mongols at Ain Jalut (1260)** — first major Mongol defeat; protected North Africa and the Islamic heartland

REGIONAL ISLAMIC STATES AFTER 1258

- › **Mamluk Sultanate (Egypt)** — slave-soldier dynasty; defeated Mongols; cultural patron
- › **Delhi Sultanate (India)** — Islamic rule over northern India; spread Islam to subcontinent
- › **Ilkhanate (Persia/Iraq)** — Mongol successor state; converted to Islam by 1295
- › **Mali Empire (West Africa)** — Islamic state connected via trans-Saharan trade
- › **Ottoman Emirate** — rising in Anatolia; conquered Constantinople 1453 (Unit 2)

WHAT CONTINUED ACROSS THE DISRUPTION

- › Five Pillars of Islam | Arabic as scholarly lingua franca
- › Indian Ocean trade dominated by Muslim merchants
- › Sharia as legal framework across diverse states
- › Pilgrimage (Hajj) to Mecca maintained cultural cohesion

AP TIP: The Mongol sack of Baghdad (1258) is the chapter's pivotal CHANGE. But Islam's continuity — spread via merchants and Sufis even into the Mongol courts — is the key complexity argument.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Dar al-Islam in 1200 = a vast, commercially dominant civilization centered on the Abbasid Caliphate. **1258 was the rupture:** Mongols sacked Baghdad and ended the Caliphate. Regional states filled the vacuum (Mamluks, Delhi Sultanate, Ilkhanate, Mali, rising Ottomans). Islam's continuity via trade networks and Sufism = the key CCOT argument.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS	NOTES
House of Wisdom <i>What was it? Where? What happened to it?</i> <i>What 4 academic fields did Islamic scholars lead in?</i> Ibn Battuta <i>Who? When? Where did he travel? Why use him in essays?</i> AP EXAM TIP Ibn Battuta's <i>Rihla</i> is a primary source for the Islamic world 1325–1354. Use him as EVIDENCE of: (1) Dar al-Islam's geographic reach, (2) trade network connectivity, (3) Islamic culture's regional variation. <i>What is a madrasa?</i> <i>How does Islamic scholarship compare to European universities in the same period?</i> COMMON MISTAKE The 'burning of the House of Wisdom' is debated by historians. Do not present it as certain fact — say the Mongols 'destroyed' Baghdad, not specifically the library.	THE HOUSE OF WISDOM (Bayt al-Hikmah) Baghdad's great translation and research institute (founded c. 830 CE). Scholars translated Greek, Persian, and Indian texts into Arabic — preserving and extending classical knowledge. Produced advances in: mathematics (algebra — al-Khwarizmi), astronomy, medicine (Ibn Sina / Avicenna), philosophy (Ibn Rushd / Averroes). ISLAMIC INTELLECTUAL CONTRIBUTIONS › Mathematics: Algebra (al-Khwarizmi), Arabic numerals transmitted to Europe › Astronomy: Accurate star charts; astrolabe refinement (helped navigation) › Medicine: Ibn Sina's <i>Canon of Medicine</i> — medical textbook used in Europe for centuries › Philosophy: Ibn Rushd's commentaries on Aristotle transmitted classical Greek thought to European Scholastics › Geography: Al-Idrisi's world map (1154) — most accurate of its era MADRASAS — Islamic Institutions of Higher Learning Schools attached to mosques that taught Islamic law, theology, and sciences. Functioned similarly to European universities. Created a class of educated religious scholars (ulama) who served as judges, teachers, and advisors across the Islamic world. Maintained intellectual continuity even after the Mongol disruption. IBN BATTUTA (1304–1368/69) › Moroccan Muslim scholar who traveled ~75,000 miles across Dar al-Islam over 30 years › Visited: North Africa, Middle East, East Africa (Swahili Coast), Central Asia, India (Delhi Sultanate), Southeast Asia, China (Yuan Dynasty) › His <i>Rihla</i> (travelogue) is the richest primary source for the Islamic world in this period › AP use: Shows geographic extent of Islam, Indian Ocean trade connectivity, and regional cultural variation within a shared Islamic framework › Historical significance: Demonstrates that Muslim scholars and merchants could travel safely across vast distances — showing the network cohesion of Dar al-Islam ULAMA — The Islamic Scholar Class Religious scholars trained in sharia and Islamic theology. Served as judges (qadis), teachers, and legal advisors. Their authority was based on religious knowledge, not hereditary nobility — a parallel to China's scholar-gentry. They maintained Islamic cultural continuity across political disruptions. AP TIP: Compare Islamic ulama to Chinese scholar-gentry — both were educated administrative elites who maintained cultural continuity across political changes. This comparison earns complexity points.
SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:	

Islamic scholarship preserved and extended classical knowledge via the House of Wisdom. Key scholars: **al-Khwarizmi** (algebra), **Ibn Sina** (medicine), **Ibn Rushd** (Aristotle). **Ibn Battuta's** travels across Dar al-Islam demonstrate the network's geographic reach. **Ulama** (compare to Chinese scholar-gentry) maintained intellectual continuity across political ruptures.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

What was the Ilkhanate?

Hulagu Khan

Who? What did he do in 1258?

Ain Jalut (1260)

Why is this battle historically significant?

AP EXAM TIP

Ain Jalut = first major Mongol defeat. Always pair it with the Mamluks. It shows that Mongol expansion was NOT inevitable or unlimited.

How did Mongol conversion to Islam represent continuity?

What was the Pax Mongolica's impact on Islamic trade?

COMMON MISTAKE

The Mongols did not destroy Islam — they were eventually absorbed into it. The Ilkhanate converted to Islam by 1295 under Ghazan Khan.

How did the Black Death connect to the Islamic world?

THE ILKHANATE — Mongol Persia (1256–1335)

Founded by **Hulagu Khan** after the sack of Baghdad (1258). Governed Persia, Iraq, and Anatolia. Initially hostile to Islam — Hulagu's wife was a Nestorian Christian, and the Mongols tolerated Buddhism and Christianity in their courts. **Ghazan Khan converted to Islam in 1295**, and the Ilkhanate gradually became an Islamic state.

BATTLE OF AIN JALUT (1260) — Turning Point

- › Fought in Palestine between the Mongols and the **Mamluk Sultanate of Egypt**
- › Mamluks won — the first decisive defeat of the Mongols in open battle
- › Stopped Mongol expansion into North Africa and the western Islamic world
- › **AP significance:** Demonstrates limits of Mongol power; Mamluks become protectors of Sunni Islam and preserve Cairo as an Islamic cultural center

MAMLUK SULTANATE (Egypt, 1250–1517)

- › **Mamluks** = slave-soldiers (mostly Turkic/Circassian) who seized power from Ayyubid dynasty
- › Defeated both Crusaders and Mongols — positioned as defenders of Islam
- › Cairo became the premier Islamic cultural capital after Baghdad's fall
- › Maintained trade through Egypt (Red Sea → Mediterranean), connecting Indian Ocean to European markets

MONGOL CONVERSION TO ISLAM

By the early 1300s, most western Mongol successor states (Ilkhanate, Golden Horde) had converted to Islam. This represents Islam's **absorption of its conquerors** — a pattern of cultural resilience. Mongol rulers became patrons of Islamic art, architecture, and scholarship.

PAX MONGOLICA AND ISLAMIC TRADE

- › Mongol control of Silk Roads reopened Central Asian trade routes
- › Muslim merchants benefited from safer overland travel under Mongol protection
- › Islamic commercial networks extended into Mongol-controlled China (Yuan Dynasty)
- › **Downside:** The same routes carried the Black Death from Central Asia westward (1340s), devastating Islamic cities including Cairo and Baghdad

AP TIP: The Mongols represent both the greatest THREAT and the greatest BOOST to Islamic commercial networks. Use this contradiction for complexity points — Mongols disrupted governance but deepened Silk Road commerce.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Mongol sack of Baghdad (1258) destroyed the Abbasid Caliphate but did NOT destroy Islam. The **Mamluks stopped the Mongols at Ain Jalut (1260)**. The Ilkhanate **converted to Islam by 1295** — Islam absorbed its conquerors. Pax Mongolica boosted Silk Road trade for Muslim merchants, but also transmitted the Black Death. Key complexity: destruction + integration + conversion.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Why did Muslim merchants dominate Indian Ocean trade?

Dhow

What is it? Who used it?

Monsoon winds

How did they enable Indian Ocean trade?

What goods moved on the Indian Ocean?

AP EXAM TIP

Indian Ocean trade = decentralized, merchant-driven, monsoon-dependent. Contrast with Silk Roads (overland, state-facilitated, Pax Mongolica-dependent). Know BOTH for comparison essays.

What role did Swahili Coast cities play?

How did the Indian Ocean trade spread Islam?

COMMON MISTAKE

Muslim merchants did NOT control Indian Ocean trade through conquest — they dominated through commercial expertise, linguistic networks, and diaspora communities.

MUSLIM DOMINANCE OF THE INDIAN OCEAN

Muslim merchants (Arab, Persian, and later Indian Muslim) dominated Indian Ocean trade from roughly 700–1500 CE. Advantages: **geographic position** (Arabia/Persia at the network's hub), **mastery of monsoon navigation**, **shared language and legal framework** (Arabic, sharia contracts), and **diaspora communities** in every major port city.

MONSOON WINDS — The Engine of Indian Ocean Trade

- › **Summer monsoons** blow northeast from Africa/Arabia toward India and SE Asia
- › **Winter monsoons** reverse, blowing southwest — enabling round-trip voyages
- › Sailors had to time voyages to the monsoon cycle — typically 1 year per round trip
- › This predictability made the Indian Ocean the world's most reliable long-distance trade system

THE DHOW — Arab Maritime Technology

Triangular-lateen-sail wooden vessel, stitched with rope rather than nailed. Highly maneuverable in monsoon winds. Smaller and less imposing than Chinese junks, but perfectly suited to Indian Ocean conditions. Arab and Persian merchants sailed dhows from East Africa to India to SE Asia.

GOODS AND TRADE FLOWS

- › **East Africa (Swahili Coast) exports:** Gold, ivory, enslaved people, iron
- › **Arabia/Persia exports:** Horses, textiles, glassware, dates
- › **India exports:** Cotton textiles, spices (pepper), indigo
- › **SE Asia exports:** Spices (nutmeg, cloves, cinnamon), tropical woods
- › **China exports:** Silk, porcelain, tea

DIASPORA COMMUNITIES AND ISLAM'S SPREAD

Muslim merchants established **diaspora communities** in port cities across the Indian Ocean — Calicut (India), Malacca (SE Asia), Kilwa (East Africa). These communities built mosques, applied sharia law to contracts, and intermarried with local elites. **Islam spread through commerce**, not conquest, in most of these areas — rulers converted to gain commercial and diplomatic advantages.

SILK ROADS — Islamic Intermediaries

- › Muslim merchants served as key intermediaries on overland Silk Roads
- › Transmitted Chinese technologies (paper, gunpowder, compass) westward to Europe
- › Pax Mongolica (1200s–1300s) temporarily boosted Silk Road traffic

AP TIP: On any essay about Indian Ocean trade, name: monsoon winds as the mechanism, Muslim merchants and diaspora communities as the agents, and Islam's spread as a key consequence.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Muslim merchants dominated Indian Ocean trade via **monsoon navigation**, **dhow technology**, and **diaspora port communities**. Trade flowed: African gold/ivory → Arabia → Indian textiles/spices → SE Asian spices → Chinese silk/porcelain. **Islam spread via commerce**, not conquest, as rulers converted for trade advantages. Muslim merchants also served as Silk Road intermediaries, transmitting Chinese innovations westward.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

3 main mechanisms of Islam's spread:

Sufism

What is it? Why was it effective at spreading Islam?

Syncretism

Define. Give 2 examples from the Islamic world.

AP EXAM TIP

AP essays often ask **HOW** Islam spread. Always name the mechanism: trade networks, Sufi missionaries, and political incentives for conversion — not forced conversion as the primary driver.

Delhi Sultanate

Was Islam spread by force there?

COMMON MISTAKE

Islam did NOT spread primarily through forced conversion. Trade, Sufi missionaries, and political incentives were far more important. The majority of conversions were voluntary.

How does Mansa Musa's pilgrimage show Islam's reach in Africa?

MECHANISM 1 — TRADE ROUTES

Muslim merchants carried Islam along every trade network. Diaspora communities in port cities built mosques and madrasas. Local rulers converted to gain access to Muslim commercial networks and the legal framework (sharia) that facilitated long-distance contracts. **Islam spread 'along the routes of trade.'**

MECHANISM 2 — SUFISM

- › **Sufis** = Islamic mystics who emphasized personal spiritual experience, music, poetry, and direct connection to God
- › Effective missionaries because they adapted to local cultures rather than demanding rigid conformity
- › Sufi orders (tariqa) established lodges across Asia and Africa, serving as centers of learning and charity
- › Made Islam accessible and appealing to people who might reject formal legalistic Islam
- › **AP example:** Sufism was critical to Islam's spread in South and Southeast Asia — blended with Hindu/Buddhist traditions

MECHANISM 3 — POLITICAL INCENTIVES

- › Rulers converted to gain: trading rights, diplomatic recognition, access to Islamic legal expertise
- › Mansa Musa (Mali) — devout Muslim who performed Hajj; conversion gave Mali prestige in the Islamic world
- › SE Asian rulers converted to gain Muslim merchant networks and sharia-based commercial law

SYNCRETISM IN PRACTICE

- › **West Africa:** Islam adopted alongside traditional religious practices; local rulers used both Islamic and indigenous ritual authority
- › **Southeast Asia:** Hindu-Buddhist traditions blended with Islamic worship; mosques incorporated local architectural styles
- › **India:** Sufi shrines became pilgrimage sites for both Muslims and Hindus
- › Result: regional variation within a shared Islamic framework

THE DELHI SULTANATE — Islam in India

Founded 1206; ruled northern India through 1526. Brought Islam to the Indian subcontinent through a combination of conquest (of Rajput kingdoms) AND accommodation of Hindu majority. **Hindus remained the majority** throughout. The Delhi Sultanate shows that Islamic political rule did NOT automatically mean mass conversion.

AP TIP: Contrast forced conversion (rare) with trade-driven syncretism (common) and Sufi missionary activity (most effective in Asia/Africa). Essays that distinguish mechanisms earn higher scores.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Islam spread primarily via: (1) **trade networks** — Muslim merchants built diaspora communities in every port; (2) **Sufism** — mystical missionaries adapted to local cultures; (3) **political incentives** — rulers converted for commercial and diplomatic advantages. Result: **syncretism** and regional variation rather than uniformity. The Delhi Sultanate shows political rule ≠ mass conversion.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Mansa Musa

Who? When did he rule? What is his AP significance?

His Hajj (1324–1325):

What happened? Why is it historically significant?

Trans-Saharan trade:

What moved? Who controlled it?

AP EXAM TIP

Mansa Musa's pilgrimage to Mecca = top AP evidence for: (1) Islam in West Africa, (2) trans-Saharan trade wealth, (3) global connections between Africa and the wider Islamic world.

Delhi Sultanate:

Dates? Key features? Who founded it?

Ottoman Empire

When did it begin? What will it do by 1453?

COMMON MISTAKE

Mansa Musa's gold distribution during his pilgrimage caused inflation in Cairo and the Middle East — it demonstrates both Mali's wealth AND the interconnectedness of the Islamic world.

MALI EMPIRE (c. 1235–1400s)

- › Founded by **Sundiata Keita** after defeating the Ghana Empire (c. 1235)
- › Controlled trans-Saharan trade in gold and salt — the wealthiest state in sub-Saharan Africa
- › Islam adopted by Mali rulers as state religion while population maintained traditional practices
- › Capital: **Niani**; major cities: **Timbuktu** and **Djenne** (centers of Islamic scholarship)

MANSA MUSA (r. 1312–1337) — Mali's Greatest Ruler

- › Performed Hajj 1324–1325; traveled to Mecca with an entourage of ~60,000 people and enormous quantities of gold
- › **Impact on Cairo:** Distributed so much gold that he caused significant inflation across North Africa and the Middle East — devaluing gold for over a decade
- › Built mosques, madrasas in Timbuktu; attracted Islamic scholars to Mali
- › **AP significance:** Put Mali on the map (literally — appeared on European maps by 1375); demonstrated the wealth generated by trans-Saharan gold trade; deepened Mali's connections to the broader Islamic world

TRANS-SAHARAN TRADE

- › **Gold** (from Mali/West Africa) → North Africa/Europe
- › **Salt** (from Saharan mines, e.g., Taghaza) → West Africa (essential for preservation)
- › **Enslaved people, ivory, kola nuts** also moved northward
- › Camel caravans crossed the Sahara; Islam and literacy traveled with the merchants

DELHI SULTANATE (1206–1526)

- › Founded by **Qutb-ud-Din Aibak** (former Mamluk general) after Turkic invasions of India
- › First major Islamic state in South Asia; ruled from Delhi over northern India
- › Repelled Mongol invasions (early 1200s–1300s) — protected India from Mongol conquest
- › Persian became the court language; Islamic architecture introduced (e.g., Qutb Minar)
- › Hindu majority remained; Islam spread through urban elites and Sufi missionaries

OTTOMAN EMIRATE (rising by 1300)

Small Turkic state in northwestern Anatolia, expanding at the expense of the weakening Byzantine Empire. By 1453 (Unit 2), Ottomans under Mehmed II will conquer Constantinople — the most significant event connecting Unit 1 to Unit 2.

AP TIP: Mali shows Islam in Africa via trade; Delhi shows Islamic political rule with Hindu majority; Ottomans show Islam's continued expansion into Christian territories. Three distinct models of Islamic power.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Three key regional Islamic states: **Mali** — trans-Saharan trade wealth; Mansa Musa's pilgrimage demonstrated global connections and gold wealth. **Delhi Sultanate** — Islamic rule in India; majority Hindu population; repelled Mongols. **Ottoman Emirate** — rising in Anatolia; will conquer Constantinople 1453. All three show Islam's continued expansion DESPITE Mongol disruption of the Abbasid center.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS	NOTES
CCOT Framework: 3 continuities and 3 changes for Ch. 2 Top 4 AP essay prompts for Ch. 2: Key comparisons for essays: AP EXAM TIP The #1 Ch. 2 AP prompt: How did Islam spread? Always specify the MECHANISM (trade, Sufism, political incentives). Never say 'it spread through conquest' as the primary driver. COMMON MISTAKES (1) Saying Mongols 'destroyed' Islam. (2) Saying Islam spread mainly by force. (3) Forgetting Ain Jalut. (4) Confusing Mansa Musa (Mali/Africa) with the Mongols. Key primary sources for Ch. 2 DBQs? Terms to define in essays:	CCOT FRAMEWORK FOR CHAPTER 2 › CONTINUITIES: Muslim merchant dominance of Indian Ocean trade Five Pillars and sharia across all Islamic states Arabic as scholarly lingua franca Hajj maintaining pan-Islamic identity › CHANGES: 1258 Mongol sack ends Abbasid Caliphate Fragmentation into regional states (Mamluks, Ilkhanate, Delhi, Mali) Ottoman rise in Anatolia Black Death disrupts Islamic cities (1340s–1350s) › COMPLEXITY: Mongols converted to Islam — conquerors absorbed into Islamic civilization TOP AP ESSAY PROMPTS › 1. LEQ: 'Analyze continuity and change in the Islamic world from 1200–1450.' → Use CCOT: trade continuity despite political rupture; 1258 as change; Mongol conversion as complexity › 2. SAQ: 'Explain ONE cause of the spread of Islam beyond the Arabian Peninsula.' → Trade networks or Sufism — specify mechanism › 3. DBQ: 'Evaluate the extent to which the Mongol conquests affected the Islamic world.' → Change: destroyed Baghdad; Continuity: trade continued, Islam survived and absorbed Mongols › 4. LEQ: 'Compare Islamic and Chinese long-distance trade networks 1200–1450.' → Indian Ocean (Muslim merchants) vs. Silk Roads/Tribute system (state-managed) KEY AP-READY COMPARISONS › Ulama vs. Chinese scholar-gentry: Both educated administrative elites maintaining cultural continuity across political change › Sufism vs. Buddhist missionaries: Both used cultural adaptation and personal religious experience to spread religion in new regions › Mamluk Egypt vs. Ming China: Both strong states that resisted Mongol pressure and reasserted traditional culture › Mansa Musa vs. Zheng He: Both demonstrated state wealth and Islamic/Chinese global connections — one via pilgrimage, one via voyages KEY PRIMARY SOURCES FOR DBQs › Ibn Battuta's Rihla: Muslim traveler — use for Indian Ocean connectivity and Islamic cultural variation › Mansa Musa accounts: Use for Mali's wealth and Islamic Africa › Marco Polo's accounts of Yuan China: Shows Islamic merchants in Chinese ports KEY TERMS TO DEFINE Dar al-Islam Ulama Madrasa Sufism Sharia Pax Mongolica Hajj Diaspora community Dhow Monsoon Syncretism Delhi Sultanate Mamluk Ilkhanate Trans-Saharan trade
SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:	

Ch. 2 AP mastery: (1) **Islam spread via trade + Sufism + political incentives** — not primarily conquest; (2) **1258 ruptured political leadership** but commercial and religious continuity persisted; (3) **Mongols converted to Islam** — use for complexity. Top comparison: **ulama vs. scholar-gentry**. Top evidence: **Ibn Battuta** and **Mansa Musa's pilgrimage**.